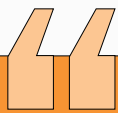


इरोरिंग इंदीव'इ प्रोब्लेम THROUGH TECHNOLOGY

Opportunities to contribute towards India's growth,
as per industry veterans

BY JAYESH SHINDE
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IOT IN HEALTHCARE AND EDUCATION

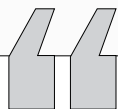
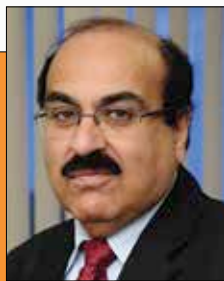
Given the potential of technology in building a better nation, the solutions it can offer are limitless. I have always been amazed by the role technology can play in bringing about change. However, I view technology as more of an enabler as opposed to supplanting governance. With the advent of a digital era, India is keen on seeking solutions to real-world problems that require less political wrangling. A digital transformation is already underway – Cloud and IoT solutions have already been adopted by various organisations. Since technology plays a pivotal role in facilitating change, it must be used to channelise the Government's efforts in the right direction.

The two major sectors where technology will certainly make headway are healthcare and education. IoT-enabled tools and devices make for easy remote access to both the patient as well as the healthcare provider. This is of key importance to critical health conditions such as cardiac care, diabetes, or cancer, to name a few. Solutions that track and report the outbreak of diseases can reduce the response time from weeks to just a few minutes.

In terms of education, we need to be able to provide education to all irrespective of one's social standing. This can only be achieved by adopting the welfare model in education, which is possible by scaling up technology to meet that end.

Technology can break barriers, provide key skills and training, and make people feel empowered."

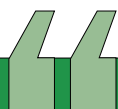
– HARISH KOHLI
MD, Acer India



DEVELOPING NEW SKILLSETS

Banking will continue to drive mobility and digitisation, whilst combining with an ecosystem of e-commerce companies. But are these technology advancements that India "needs"? A key problem we need to solve for is education. A significant reason for the growth that India saw from 1991 onwards is because of the growth in professional services, especially in IT/ITeS. It is ironic how this sector is now challenged in keeping pace with fast emerging digital innovations. New skillsets need to be taught at grassroots levels and curriculums need to be adapted for India to continue to retain its numero uno position in this sector. One cannot dismiss the concerns of privacy, security and cybercrime either. In a BCG survey across 13,570 consumers across 21 countries, Indians ranked as the most concerned, with 44% fearing their private data would be made public and 40% fearing it would be stolen. We need a more modernised legal framework to stay in step with rapidly emerging technological standards."

– RAJIV GUPTA
Head, Technology Advantage Practice, BCG India



FINANCIAL INCLUSION

The country has huge challenges, but within these challenges lie huge opportunities. Use of technology is the only way to address challenges such as eradication of poverty, improving literacy, improving agricultural yield, reducing traffic congestion, providing healthcare to all, etc. As per the Global Findex 2014 report, India has 21% of the world's unbanked adults. The high penetration and adoption of telecom services provides a practical solution for financial inclusion. Services like M-Pesa and Airtel Money are popular in developing countries like Kenya and expected to be successful in India. Smartphones provide new opportunities for mobile-wallet players UID project and smartcards will boost the efficiency of payment for pensions, subsidies, NREGA payments and KYC based authentications."

– HEMANT JOSHI
Partner, Deloitte Haskins & Sells LLP

